Catch it being wrong

Lesson 3: audit an answer against real books.

Check the Source · 45 minutes

If every book is real, how could the answer still be wrong?

- The overview was written **before** the books were found.
- It can **sound sure** about a date, a name, or a cause and still be guessing.
- A book can be about the **topic** but not the **claim**.
- The **Record** can be thin, so you may need the book itself.

What it's good and bad at

Ask about almost anything

Any subject, math included. The overview is often a useful start.

It can be wrong about any of it

Multi-step math especially. Check the steps yourself or in a book.

It's strongest at finding books in our collection, because that part comes straight from our Catalog.

Four steps

1

Question

What does the answer claim? What might be missing?

2

Check

What evidence supports it? Which claims need checking?

3

Compare

Check it against reliable sources: the Record, then the book.

4

Decide

What is trustworthy, what needs fixing, what shouldn't be used?

From Wisconsin DPI's Ethical Use in the Classroom guidance.

Three verdicts

✔ Checked

A book backs it up.

✘ Wrong

A book contradicts it.

○ Not in our books

Nothing we own covers it, so it stays unchecked here.

> "It's AI so it's probably wrong" is not a verdict. **Show the line** that contradicts it.

Watch one audit

What does it claim? What would prove it? Where do we look? What's the verdict, and why?

Your turn: audit the set

- Work through the printed answers with the **Answer audit** on the back of your handout.
- Take each claim to the **Record**, then the **book**.
- When Compare needs the book, the **runner** goes to the shelf.

Live round

Ask two questions of your own and audit the answers the same way.

Try one near the edge of the collection:

> Do we have anything about …?

What did you catch?

- Share your most interesting verdict.
- **Which kind of mistake was hardest to catch?**

> A wrong claim above a list of real books is hard to spot: the books make the whole answer look checked.